

Endless Possibilities With ChatGPT

Most people who use ChatGPT are only scratching the surface — and don't even know it. They type a question, get an answer, and call it a day.

It works — but it's a fraction of what the tool can actually do. There's a whole layer of modes and features that completely changes how you interact with it, and this course is where you find out what you've been missing.



Your First ChatGPT Challenge

Imagine you're preparing for a job interview. You need company research, a tailored answer to "tell me about yourself," and three practice questions — all from ChatGPT. Using the same approach for all three would slow you down.

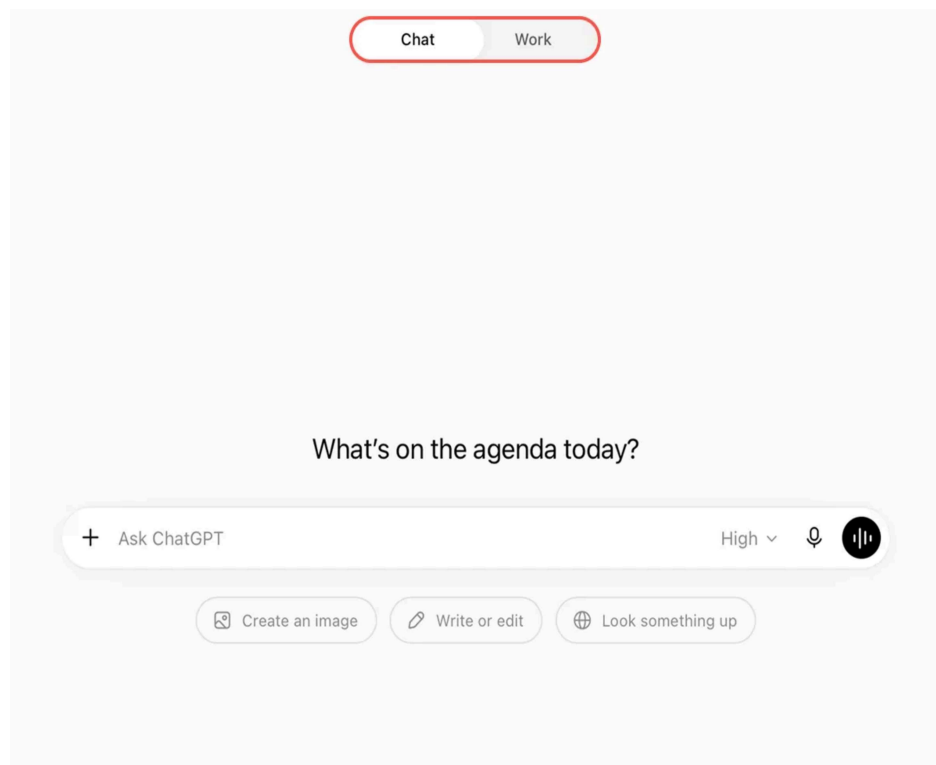
This lesson shows you how to match the right ChatGPT intelligence level and feature to the right task.

Before You Dive In

Open ChatGPT, and the home page offers two modes: **Chat** and **Work**. Chat is where everyday tasks happen — questions, drafts, and research.

Work is the power mode: an advanced workspace with extra settings for specialized, heavy-duty tasks.

This course sticks with Chat: it covers most tasks you'll run into daily. Work gets its own deep dive in a separate course.

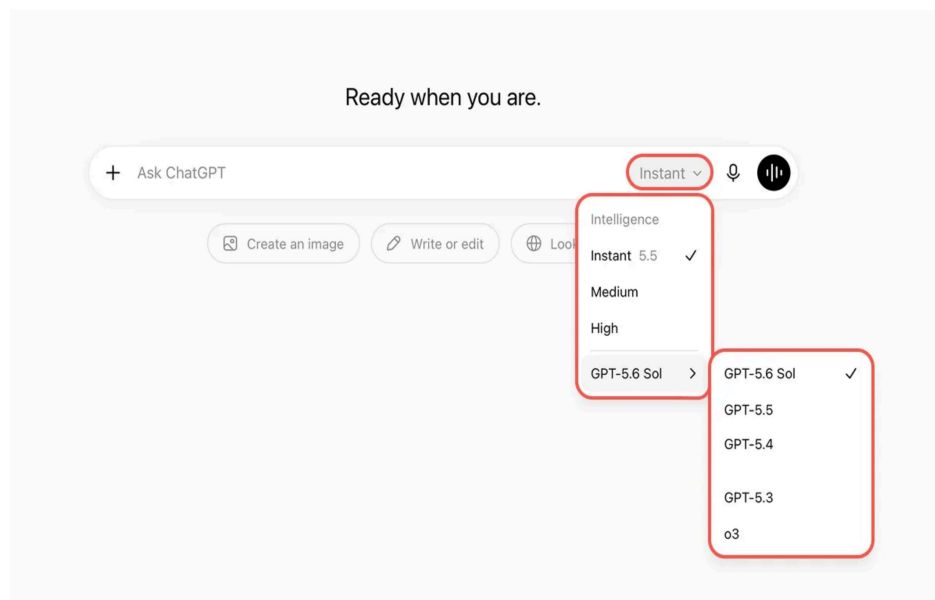


ChatGPT runs on a family of models that keep updating. The latest generation, **GPT-5.6**, comes in three tiers:

- **Sol** — the flagship and most capable
- **Terra** — balances capability, speed, and cost
- **Luna** — the fastest and lowest-cost in the family

Tiers and availability may change over time. In a standard ChatGPT conversation, however, you usually choose a **reasoning level**, not a model.

That reasoning level is the **Intelligence** setting. It has three levels — **Instant**, **Medium**, and **High** (Pro plans unlock a few more) — and the one you pick shapes how much reasoning ChatGPT puts into your response.



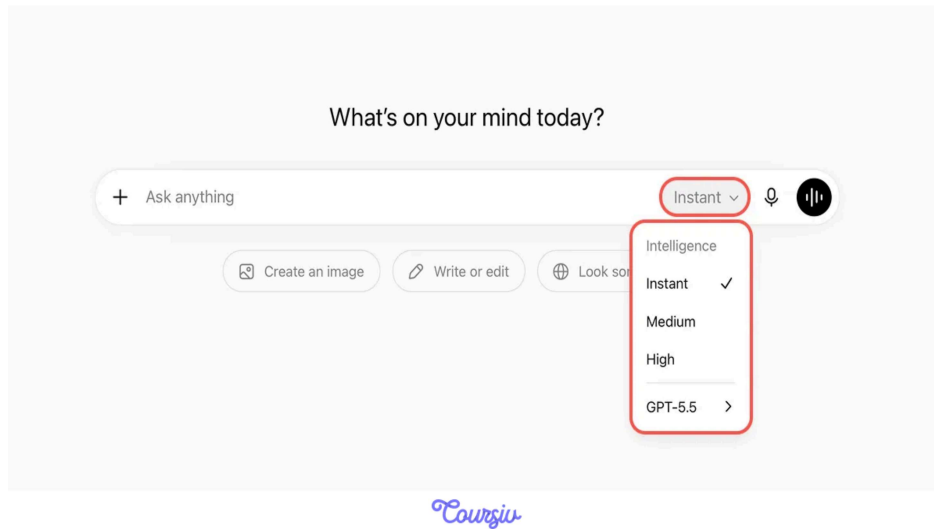
Say you need to quickly write a summary section in your resume ASAP. What would you choose?

- ☐ A level built to think longer and go deeper
- ☐ A level built for speed and immediate output

✓ Correct answer

When speed matters and the task is straightforward, you want an immediate answer, not extra depth.

For quick, straightforward tasks, **Instant** is your best pick. It's the fastest option, designed for everyday questions and immediate results.



✓ Task completed

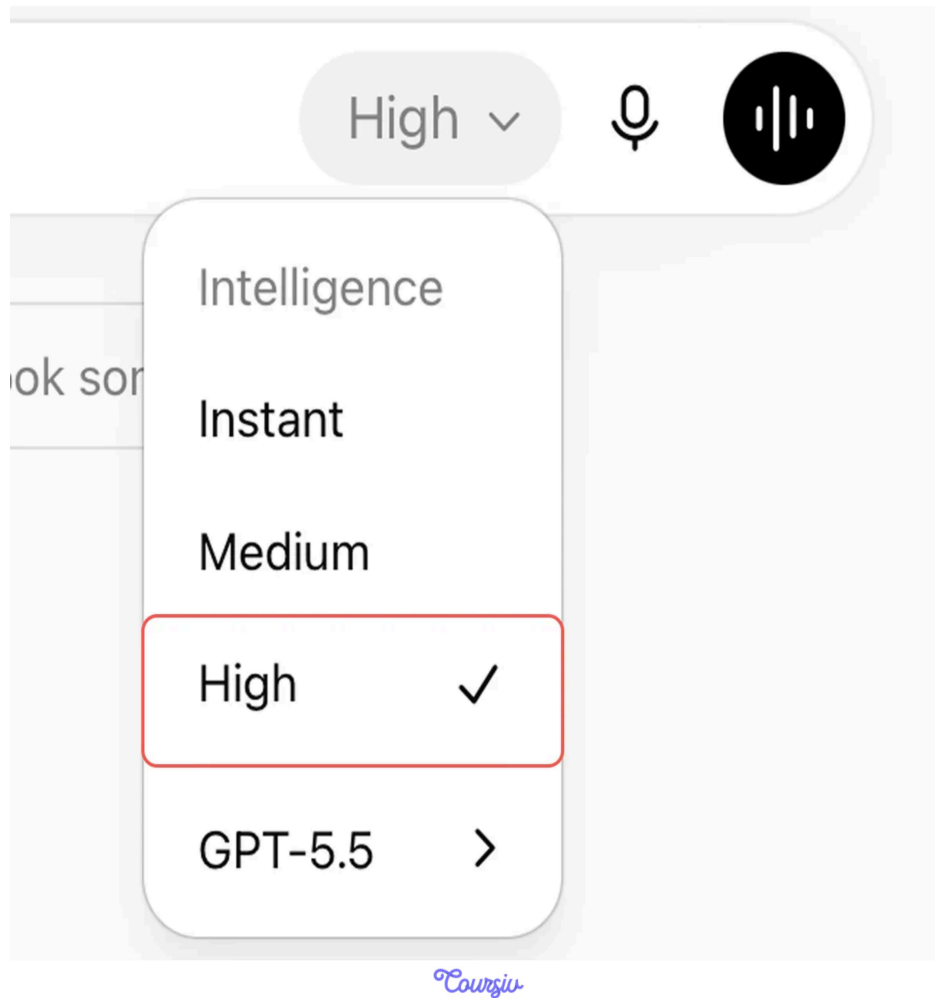
Task Challenge

Now, evaluate this task and decide if it's simple or complex.

 Repeat task

A multi-step task like this benefits from more reasoning. This is exactly what **Medium** and **High** are built for.

Both spend more time thinking than Instant, so expect a slower (but deeper) response.



Prefer to skip the choice? Turn on **Higher intelligence** so Instant scales up to a higher intelligence level when a task needs deeper thinking. Find it in **Settings** → **General**.



💡 First Discovery

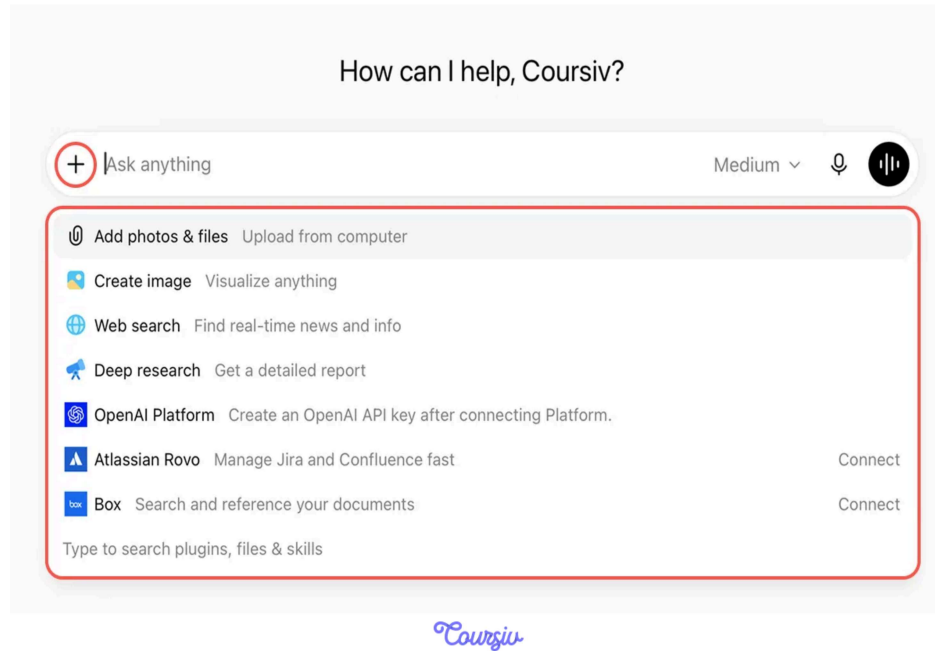
Think of **Intelligence** as different gears:

- **Instant** — fast responses for everyday tasks
- **Medium** — standard reasoning for tasks that need more analysis
- **High** — extended reasoning for complex, multi-step work
- **Higher intelligence** lets ChatGPT move between Instant and Medium for you

Pick the gear that matches the task, or let auto-switch decide.

Choosing the right intelligence level is just the beginning. ChatGPT also has specialized *features* that enhance specific types of tasks.

Let's explore which features work best for different scenarios.



Looking at the screenshot above, which ChatGPT feature would be most helpful for an interview prep task we discussed earlier?

☐ Deep research

☐ File uploads

Web search

✓ Correct answer

Web search quickly finds up-to-date company info and news. This is exactly what you need for interview prep without over-complicating the task.

But why doesn't Deep Research fit if you need to research the company, in your opinion?

Select all possible answers

The task only needs a quick, recent overview

Deep Research generally takes longer than Web Search

Deep Research is better for multi-step, in-depth work across multiple sources

☐ It requires uploading source documents before use

✓ Correct answer

Deep Research handles complex analysis over time — think academic papers or comprehensive reports. For quick company info, Web Search is faster and sufficient.

ChatGPT's Features

You've just identified which features fit which tasks.

Now, let's understand what each feature does and when to use it.

Feature 1: Web Search

Web Search, as mentioned above, pulls current information from the internet — news, company updates, and recent developments.

It's perfect for: company research, current events, and recent product launches.



Let's use the job-hunt scenario: you're preparing for an interview at Nike and need their latest news. Try it.

✓ Task completed

Try Web Search in Action

Ask for web information about Nike's sports clothing division with a Web search.

 Repeat task

Web Search pulled current Nike news directly into the chat — no digging through news sites yourself. For deeper analysis, switch to **Deep Research**.

Feature 2: Deep Research

Deep Research is built for multi-step, in-depth questions. It can search the web, use uploaded files and connected apps, and produce a structured report with citations.

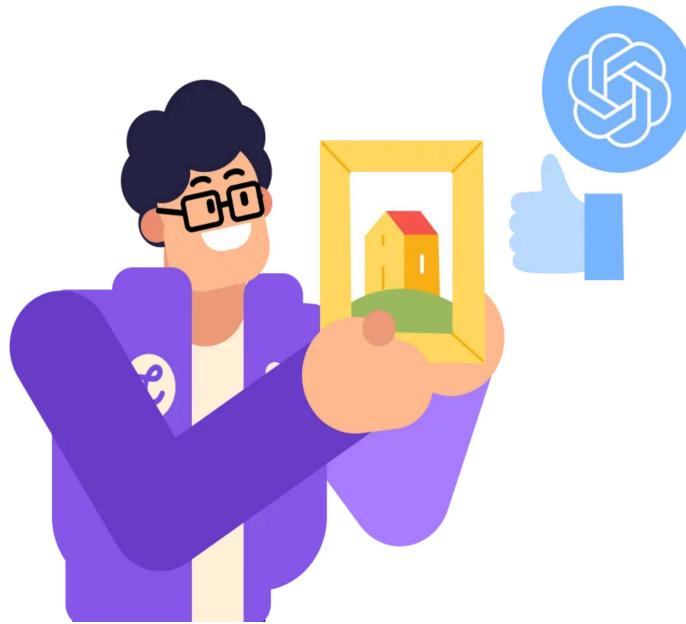
Use it for: market analysis, literature reviews, competitive research, and detailed decision briefs.



Feature 3: Add Photos & Files

The **Add Photos & Files** feature lets you upload images, PDFs, presentations, text documents, and spreadsheets. ChatGPT can summarize them, compare them, extract information, answer questions about their contents, or analyze their data.

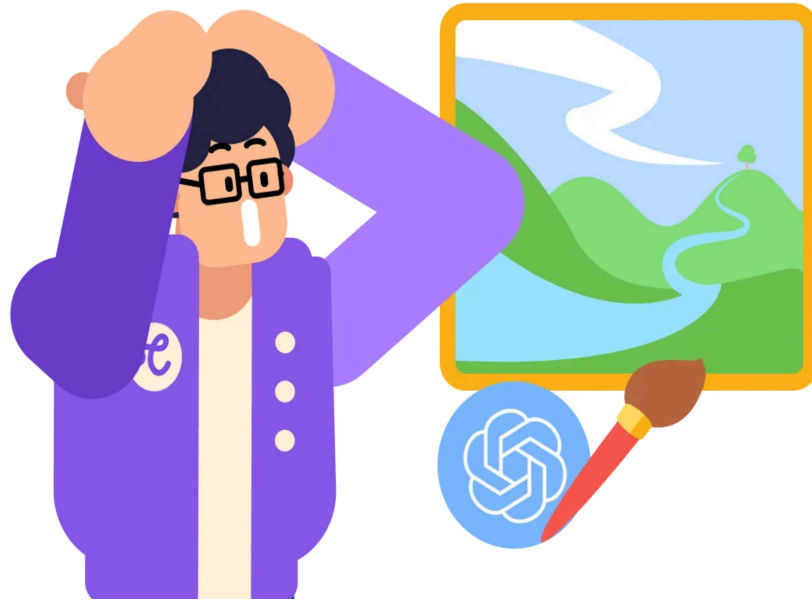
Examples: edit an uploaded resume, analyze a spreadsheet, summarize a PDF, or interpret a screenshot.



Feature 4: Create Image

Beyond processing images, ChatGPT can also **create and edit images**. Describe what you need visually, and ChatGPT generates it.

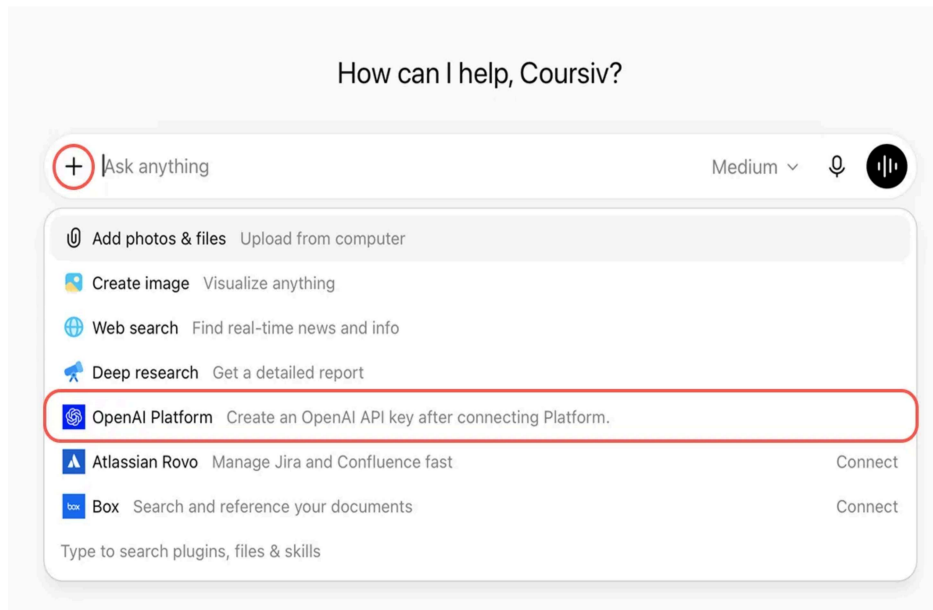
Use this for: portfolio visuals, brand logos, presentation graphics, social media visuals, or just for fun.



OpenAI Platform

In the toolkit, you'll also see **OpenAI Platform**. It's the developer side of ChatGPT — an API to build your own apps, workflows, and integrations. ChatGPT is the ready-made app you use here; OpenAI Platform is the toolkit for building your own.

Below the features menu, you can also search for **plugins, files, and skills** — like Study and Learn for study plans and quizzes, or others tailored to your work.



Coursiv

💡 Second Discovery

ChatGPT's features are tools in a toolkit:

- **Web Search** for current info (fast)
- **Deep Research** for comprehensive analysis (slow)
- **Files & Photos** for analyzing uploads
- **Image Creation** for visual content

Pick the tool that matches the job.

Matching Intelligence and Features to Tasks

Now, let's practice choosing the right intelligence level and feature for different job-search scenarios.

✓ Task completed

Feature Match

Match each task with the most appropriate ChatGPT feature.

 Repeat task

Let's combine both: an intelligence level and a feature together. Say you want a quick overview of Nike's corporate culture before an interview.

You'd select **Instant** — the task is straightforward, no deep reasoning needed — and **Web search** to pull live information.

✓ Task completed

Try Instant + Web Search

Ask for a quick overview of Nike's corporate culture with Instant and Web Search.

 Repeat task

You can now match ChatGPT's intelligence levels and features to different task types and combine them.

This skill multiplies your prompting effectiveness. Knowing how to ask matters, but knowing which tool to use matters just as much.

Key Takeaways

- **Intelligence levels affect speed and reasoning:** Instant for everyday tasks, Medium for standard reasoning, and High for more complex work. Some plans include additional levels.
- **Auto-switch handles the choice for you.** Let Instant scale up to Medium when tasks need more thought.
- **Features add capabilities beyond text:** Web search, Deep research, Add photos & files, Create image, OpenAI Platform.

- **Combine level + feature for the right fit:** Like Instant + Web search for a fast company overview.

What's Next?

Next, you'll discover a feature most users walk straight past — **Voice Mode**: a completely different way to interact with ChatGPT that fits certain tasks better than typing.

Stay tuned!

